

Note: The source specification document does not contain a user stories backlog. The stories below have been derived from the product overview, service specifications, and API/event contracts to give the team a starting backlog. They should be reviewed, re-estimated, and refined with the product owner before sprint planning.

Epic 1: Authentication & Identity

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
AUTH-1	As a new user, I want to register with my email and password, so that I can create a SplitSpend account.	Must Have	Account created only after validation; user.registered event emitted; duplicate emails rejected
AUTH-2	As a new user, I want to verify my email via OTP, so that my account is confirmed as genuine.	Must Have	OTP expires after set window; user.verified event emitted on success
AUTH-3	As a registered user, I want to log in with my credentials, so that I can access my account.	Must Have	JWT + refresh token returned; failed attempts tracked toward logout
AUTH-4	As a user, I want my session to refresh automatically, so that I'm not logged out mid-use.	Should Have	Refresh token rotates on use; old token invalidated
AUTH-5	As a user, I want to set a transaction PIN, so that my transfers and payments are protected.	Must Have	PIN stored hashed; required before any transfer or payment approval
AUTH-6	As a user, I want to reset my password if I forget it, so that I can regain access to my account.	Must Have	Reset token single-use and time-limited
AUTH-7	As a user, I want repeated failed logins to lock my account, so that my funds are protected from brute-force attacks.	Must Have	Account locks after threshold; unlock path defined

Epic 2: Wallet & Balance Management

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
WAL-1	As a user, I want to view my Main Balance and Budget Balance, so that I know what I have available to spend.	Must Have	GET /api/wallets/{userId} returns both balances in real time
WAL-2	As a user, I want a spend to draw from my Budget Balance first and fall back to Main Balance, so that I'm never blocked from paying when my daily budget runs out.	Must Have	Budget-first debit logic; correct event (wallet.budget.debited or wallet.main.debited) emitted depending on source
WAL-3	As a user, I want to see a full ledger of every credit and debit on my wallet, so that I can audit my spending history.	Must Have	Ledger includes before/after balance and debit type; paginated
WAL-4	As a user, I want to be notified immediately if a payment fails due to insufficient funds, so that I understand why the transaction didn't go through.	Must Have	wallet.insufficient_funds triggers push + SMS notification
WAL-5	As the system, I want every financial operation to carry an idempotency key, so that retried requests never cause double-processing.	Must Have	Duplicate IdempotencyKey rejected before any ledger write

Epic 3: Budget Management

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
BUD-1	As a user, I want to create a daily spending budget from my Main Balance, so that I can enforce discipline on my own spending.	Must Have	Funds transferred Main → Budget atomically; budget.created then budget.activated on confirmation
BUD-2	As a user, I want my budget to automatically release a portion each day, so that I don't have to manually manage daily limits.	Must Have	CRON releases daily amount at fixed time; budget.daily.released emitted
BUD-3	As a user, I want unused daily budget to expire and return to my Main Balance at day's end, so that I don't lose access to unspent money.	Must Have	CRON expires unused amount; budget.daily.expired emitted; Wallet credits Main Balance
BUD-4	As a user, I want to cancel an active budget, so that I can get my remaining funds back if my plans change.	Should Have	Remaining balance returned to Main; budget.cancelled emitted; gift budgets excluded
BUD-5	As a parent, I want to set and fund a daily spending budget for my child remotely, so that I can control their university spending discipline without being physically present.	Must Have	Same budget engine applied cross-account; parent retains visibility of child's daily limit
BUD-6	As a user, I want to send a gift budget to another user, so that I can help fund a friend or family member's spending discipline.	Should Have	gift.sent emitted; receiver's Budget Balance credited; gift budgets cannot be cancelled

Epic 4: In-Platform Payments (Vendor & User-to-User)

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
PAY-1	As a user, I want to request payment from another user via QR code or UserId, so that I can receive money instantly with zero fees.	Must Have	vendor.payment.requested emitted; payer notified immediately
PAY-2	As a payer, I want to approve or reject a payment request, so that I control what leaves my wallet.	Must Have	Approval triggers atomic Wallet debit+credit; rejection moves no money
PAY-3	As a payer, I want unanswered payment requests to expire automatically, so that stale requests don't linger indefinitely.	Should Have	2-minute window enforced; vendor.payment.expired emitted, no money moves
PAY-4	As a user, I want to pay another SplitSpend user directly without any transfer fee, so that in-platform payments are instant and free.	Must Have	Purely internal wallet move; no Paystack call involved
PAY-5	As a vendor, I want to see the status of all payment requests I've sent, so that I can track which have been paid, rejected, or expired.	Should Have	GET /api/pay/{userId}/requests returns full status history

Epic 5: External Bank Transfers

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
TRF-1	As a user, I want to transfer money from my Main Balance to any Nigerian bank account, so that I can move funds out of the platform when needed.	Must Have	PIN required; Wallet pre-debits Main Balance before Paystack payout call
TRF-2	As a user, I want to verify the account name before sending a transfer, so that I don't send money to the wrong account.	Must Have	POST /api/transfers/verify-account resolves name from account number + bank
TRF-3	As a user, I want a failed transfer to automatically refund my Main Balance, so that I never lose money due to a failed bank payout.	Must Have	transfer.failed triggers Wallet reversal of the pre-debit
TRF-4	As a user, I want to see the status and history of all my external transfers, so that I can track where my money has gone.	Must Have	GET /api/transfers/{userId} lists all transfers with current status
TRF-5	As the system, I want transfers stuck in Pending beyond 24 hours to be automatically reconciled, so that no user's funds are left in limbo.	Must Have	Scheduled poll checks Paystack status every 30 min; auto-reversal after timeout

Epic 6: Deposits

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
DEP-1	As a user, I want to deposit money into my SplitSpend wallet via bank transfer to my virtual account, so that I can fund my Main Balance.	Must Have	Paystack webhook verified via HMAC; payment.successful emitted; Wallet credited
DEP-2	As a user, I want to manually check the status of a deposit that hasn't reflected yet, so that I can confirm whether my money is safe.	Should Have	GET /api/payments/verify/{ref} re-checks against Paystack directly
DEP-3	As a user, I want to view my deposit history, so that I can confirm all my past top-ups.	Should Have	GET /api/payments/{userId}/history returns full deposit list

Epic 7: Transaction History & Visibility

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
TXN-1	As a user, I want to view a unified history of all my transactions (deposits, payments, transfers, gifts), so that I have one place to review all my activity.	Must Have	GET /api/transactions/{userId} filterable by type, date, status
TXN-2	As a user, I want to see the detailed status of a specific transaction, so that I understand exactly what happened and when.	Should Have	GET /api/transactions/{id} returns full lifecycle detail

TXN-3	As a user, I want my home screen to show my balances, today's remaining budget, and recent activity in one view, so that I don't need multiple screens to see my financial status.	Must Have	Aggregated GET /api/dashboard/{userId} combines Wallet + Budget + Transaction data
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Epic 8: Notifications

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
NOT-1	As a user, I want to receive a push notification immediately when a payment request is sent to me, so that I can respond within the approval window.	Must Have	Push delivered on vendor.payment.requested, marked urgent
NOT-2	As a user, I want to be notified when my daily budget is released, so that I know my spending money for the day is available.	Should Have	Push delivered on budget.daily.released
NOT-3	As a user, I want to be notified when a transfer completes or fails, so that I always know the outcome of money leaving my account.	Must Have	Push + SMS on transfer.completed and transfer.failed
NOT-4	As a user, I want to receive an email when someone sends me a gift budget, so that I have a durable record of the gift.	Could Have	Push + Email delivered on gift.sent

Epic 9: Platform Reliability & Observability (Engineering-Facing)

ID	User Story	Priority	Acceptance Criteria
OPS-1	As an on-call engineer, I want to trace a single user request across all services it touches, so that I can debug failures quickly.	Must Have	OpenTelemetry Traceld propagated through HTTP + Kafka; visible in Application Insights
OPS-2	As an on-call engineer, I want to search structured logs across all 9 services in one place, so that I don't need to SSH into each service individually.	Must Have	Serilog → Seq central log search working for all services
OPS-3	As an on-call engineer, I want to be alerted if the daily budget CRON job fails to fire, so that user-impacting failures are caught before users notice.	Must Have	Alert configured for "CRON not fired by 06:10 AM"
OPS-4	As a platform operator, I want services to discover each other dynamically via Consul, so that deployments and scaling don't require hardcoded service addresses.	Must Have	Consul health checks passing; API Gateway routes only to healthy instances

Backlog Summary

Priority

Story Count	
Must Have	24
Should Have	9
Could Have	1
Total	34